

Duc Nguyen

Project 3 Design Activism

In my project, I am designing a shirt that celebrates biromanticism as sexuality.

Biromanticism, which is less commonly known than bisexuality, refers to when a person is romantically attracted to people of two specific and distinct gender identities. Biromantic individuals may not be sexually attracted to the same people they're romantically attracted to, and they may identify as biromantic asexual, bisexual, heterosexual, homosexual, or pansexual.

As someone who identifies more as biromantic than bisexual, I am often frustrated by having to explain what biromanticism means. I want my shirt to help me express my identity without having to explain it to others constantly. To achieve this, I have included a bold QR code on the shirt that leads to the biromanticism definition page on WebMD. The message "Bi code Bitch" is a powerful statement that encourages people to scan the code and learn more about biromanticism. While the tone of the message may seem harsh, I see it as a way to demonstrate pride in my identity. I also want my shirt to be white and the design to have the Bi-color flag. Because I want this shirt can be worn by anyone, regardless of gender or sexual orientation. This is because people also often target and shame hetero-presenting relationships, which also damage the Bi community and non-queer presenting relationship. This inclusivity helps to break down the rigid boxes that society often places individuals and their partners in based on how society views them.

Shirts are a highly visible form of expression that can be worn anywhere, making them a powerful tool for communicating a message to a broad audience. According to Vogue, wearing a t-shirt turns the wearer into a walking billboard, and the message becomes part of their identity.

This can spark conversations and promote awareness in a personal and immediate way.

Additionally, shirts can express unity and solidarity to those who wear them, helping to create and empower communities.

Creating and empowering communities is a critical aspect of the Social Change Model of Leadership, where community falls under the categories of the model. Wearing a shirt is a small but meaningful way to support a community by spreading its message. I believe that my design should speak for its wearer, and shirts are a fantastic medium for this idea. This shirt is for people who feel like they have to hide under a recognizable term because they are tired of constantly explaining themselves. Scanning the QR code also shows unity and a willingness to learn from people, including those outside of the community. This helps create a safe space for people to explore and explain different aspects of themselves.

Ultimately, I hope that my shirt serves as a tool for people to express their sexuality and provide information to educate others. I also believe that my shirt can help build a community of support for those who wear it by demonstrating that there are people who are willing to learn and support them.

Works Cited

“Biromantic: What Does It Mean?” WebMD, WebMD, <https://www.webmd.com/sex/what-does-biromantic-mean>.

“Raise Awareness and Promote Your Advocacy with a Shirt.” Shirts and Prints Ph, 7 Aug. 2019, <https://shirtsandprints.ph/2019/08/07/raise-awareness-and-promote-your-advocacy-with-a-shirt/>.

Remsen, Nick. "The Role of the T-Shirt in the Fight for Social Justice." *British Vogue*, 8 May 2021, <https://www.vogue.co.uk/fashion/article/power-of-t-shirts-for-activism>.